FlowTree User Guide

A private visual workspace for planning your monthly income, commitments, goals, and future funds.

What FlowTree shows

FlowTree is a monthly plan, not a bank balance or transaction tracker. It turns income into a left-to-right funding tree: income → monthly plan → categories → individual destinations. Amounts that recur yearly are shown as their monthly equivalent (annual amount ÷ 12).

Start on Home

Home is the working view. The monthly-plan root stays open, while categories and child branches can be opened or closed to focus the view. Select a node for details, then use the info control to understand its type. The info icon uses the same semantic color as that node.

- **Expand everything** reveals every funding branch; choose it again to return to the focused view.
- **Available** is money left after the displayed plan. **Over-planned** means the plan needs adjustment.
- The safety buffer is reserved before category allocation; sibling order is funding priority.

Navigate planning views

Use the sidebar to move between Home, Full tree, Sinking funds, Loans, and Life goals. Full tree shows the whole structure. Sinking funds collects future annual or irregular costs as monthly targets. Loans summarizes principal, rate, tenure, EMI, remaining balance, and the monthly split between principal and interest. Life goals keeps long-range targets visible without losing their connection to the main plan.

Edit your plan

Select a category or destination and choose its edit action to update its amount, funding status, or children. A parent can have its own direct monthly amount plus child destinations; FlowTree counts that money once. Use the add actions for income sources, categories, subscriptions, loans, sinking funds, and goals.

Appearance and accounts

Select your profile at the bottom of the sidebar. This one menu keeps account actions and appearance together: switch between light and dark mode, sign in to Google Drive, and choose a different signed-in account. When an account has a Google profile picture, the Home flow uses that picture for the person marker; otherwise it uses the standard person icon.

Your data and Google Drive

Your plan remains private to your browser until you choose Google Drive sign-in. With Drive connected, FlowTree uses the narrow drive.file permission and saves only the plan file it creates for your account. It does not read Gmail, Calendar, Contacts, or your general Drive contents. The save indicator confirms when the active plan is saved to that connected Drive account.

Edit the plan as JSON

With Drive connected, open the profile menu and choose **Edit plan JSON**. This shows the same simple document stored in Drive. Keep IDs unique, use numbers for monetary values, and preserve the tree structure. FlowTree validates the file before it replaces your active plan.

Keep the plan useful

Review Available or Over-planned each month, keep yearly costs in Sinking funds, revisit loan assumptions when you make extra payments, and add goals only when their monthly impact is intentional. The tree is most useful when it mirrors the order in which you want each part of your income funded.